SYLLABUS FOR COMM 104: Public Speaking
Fall 2026

104-05: MWF 10am-10:50am, 110 Maybank Hall
104-06: MWF 11am-11:50am, 110 Maybank Hall
104-07: MWF 1pm-1:50pm, 110 Maybank Hall
104-08: MWF 2pm-2:50pm, 110 Maybank Hall

Professor: Dr. Brook Irving
Office: 7 College Way, Room 307

Email: irvingba@cofc.edu

Office Hours: Monday, 3-4pm
Wednesday, 3-4pm
and by appointment

COURSE DESCRIPTION AND OBJECTIVES

Catalog Description
The fundamentals of oral communication as they pertain to public speaking. An introduction to the techniques and skills involved in preparing and delivering various types of speeches. Attention is given to voice, diction, and platform presence.

Prerequisites: None

Course Description
The centrality of public speaking to civic life, and to more specific vocational practices, dates to back antiquity. The adept public speaker in classical times was the cultural and political leader of their community. The importance of public speaking in contemporary life is no less severe. And as global shifts in economic, political, and cultural boundaries have taken place, so too have the constraints and profound obligations public discourse has in the world. This course introduces students to the historical context of rhetorical expression and provides the foundations for performing public communication acts. This course will discuss the major genres of public speech acts, the organizational strategies applicable in various speech situations, and appropriate delivery and style choices. In addition, this course introduces basic research skills and offers an introduction to the fundamentals of argumentation.

Course Objectives
By the end of this course students should be able to demonstrate the ability to:
1. Choose and adapt an appropriate topic for a specific audience, occasion and purpose, using proper tone, style, format, and grammar in oral argument.
2. Use appropriate organizational and outlining strategies to present information and arguments.

3. Create and use appropriate visual aids, including electronic presentation technology, to enhance the presentation.
4. Use scholarly and public databases to research topics and issues.
5. Understand and demonstrate adherence to research style guidelines.
6. Demonstrate effective nonverbal behavior in message delivery.
7. Demonstrate active listening skills.

REQUIRED MATERIALS

TO ACQUIRE FROM THE BOOKSTORE:

Gunn, Joshua. *Speech Craft*. 2nd ed., Bedford/St. Martin's, 2021. ISBN: 9781319201562.

Selected Readings.

Consistent access to OAKS. Some of your readings are posted on OAKS. All of your assignment prompts are posted on OAKS. **You need to make sure you are able to access OAKS regularly to keep up with the requirements for this course. Please note that the College has implemented a mandatory laptop policy. Please visit the following link for more information about requirements and institutional support regarding this policy: https://it.cofc.edu/laptops/.**

GRADING POLICY

A	93-100
A-	90-92
B+	87-89
B	83-86
B-	80-82
C+	77-79
C	73-76
C-	70-72
D+	67-69
D	63-66
D-	60-62
F	59 & below

As frustrating as it may seem, grades serve as an important analytical scale for assessing student performance. As such, they are not suggestions or the result of a negotiation between professor and student. This course is made up of a total of 1000 points. Grades will be posted to OAKS as you accrue points over the semester. It is a good idea to continue to track your progress and keep upcoming assignments and point distributions in mind as you plan your performance in the course.

If you have a question about a grade, please wait 24 hours before reaching out. **Remember to read all feedback before contacting me about a grade question**. This course is rooted in basic argumentation theory. If you have a grade dispute you will be asked to use the argumentation skills we are learning in the course to construct a written argument in favor of a grade change.

HOMEWORK SUBMISSIONS AND LATE WORK

This course requires that you pay close attention to our calendar and submit work in the required timeline (per the syllabus and OAKS). Most of your work will be submitted digitally through the

OAKS platform this semester. It is solely your responsibility to stay on top of these obligations. Here are some key points to note regarding class requirements.

1. Most of your written work will be submitted into the OAKS dropbox dedicated for that assignment. Typically assignment prompts can be found within the dropbox. These files should be uploaded as .**docx or .pdf files. Please don't upload your documents as .pages files.** Pay attention to the due time for these assignments, they can differ based on the assignment requirements. Please give yourself at least five minutes wiggle room to make sure you have time to upload your work into the dropbox in its entirety.

2. I do not accept late work via email. Please upload late work to the dropbox designated for late work entitled LATE WORK. Late work will only be accepted for the 48-hour period following the initial assignment deadline. NOTE: LATE WORK IS SUBJECT TO AN INITIAL 10% GRADE DEDUCTION, AND A SUBSEQUENT 10% GRADE DEDUCTION FOR EVERY 24-HOUR PERIOD UNTIL SUBMISSION.

OFFICE HOURS

Office hours will be held each week in my office: 7 College Way, Room 307. You can drop in for these hours; no appointment is necessary. I am happy to meet with you at a time of your choosing if my standing office hours don't work for you. We can arrange these meetings over email. I can arrange to meet you on Zoom if I am not in my office. Please note my office is on the second floor of 7 College Way. If stairs are an issue please let me know and we can meet at another location on campus. My favorite part of this job is talking with, and learning from, you. Please come in to see me frequently! Student success in the classroom is linked to the frequency with which you meet with your professors.

COMMUNICATION

Throughout the course of this semester, we will continue to address the centrality of ethics in the development of communication theory and rhetorical prowess. You will be asked to perform this knowledge in our interactions, in the way you frame your ideas, interact with classmates, and address your professor. Remember to treat your peers with respect, in tone, word choice, and framing. The college classroom is a truly special place, where you have the opportunity to share your ideas, think through complicated social, cultural, and political issues, and increase your understanding of complicated conceptual schemata. This requires an active and ongoing commitment to respect, understanding, and care for others. Disrespectful communication and/or behavior will not be tolerated.

ATTENDANCE POLICY

This course is conducted in-person. Attendance is required to complete in-class quizzes and your listening and audience analyses. If you are absent on an audience analysis date you may make up the assignment for partial credit IF YOU MAKE ARRANGEMENTS TO DO SO IN ADVANCE. You are permitted to miss up to five in-class quizzes with no impact on your grade.

HONOR CODE AND ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

As members of the College of Charleston community, we affirm, embrace and hold ourselves accountable to the core values of integrity, academic excellence, liberal arts education, respect for

the individual student, diversity, equity and inclusion, student centeredness, innovation and public mission. Congruent with these core values, the College of Charleston expects that every student and community member has a responsibility to uphold the standards of the honor code, as outlined in the Student Handbook, In pursuit of academic learning, you are expected to reference the work of other scholars, and complete your own academic work, while utilizing appropriate resources for assistance. Any acts of suspected academic dishonesty will be reported to the Office of the Dean of Students and addressed through the conduct process. Your adherence to these practices and expectations plays a vital role in fostering a campus culture that balances trust and the pursuit of knowledge while producing a strong foundation of academic excellence at the College of Charleston. Any questions regarding these expectations can be clarified by your instructor.

ACCOMODATIONS

I am happy to work with all students to ensure that they have equal access to the educational experience of this class. The College will make reasonable accommodations for persons with documented disabilities. Students should apply for services at the Center for Disability Services/SNAP located on the first floor of the Lightsey Center, Suite 104. Students approved for accommodations are responsible for notifying me as soon as possible and for contacting me one week before accommodation is needed.

The Center for Disability Services/SNAP is committed to assisting qualified students with disabilities achieve their academic goals by providing reasonable academic accommodations under appropriate circumstances. If you have a disability and anticipate the need for an accommodation in order to participate in this class, please connect with the Center for Disability Services/SNAP. They will assist you in getting the resources you may need to participate fully in this class. You can contact the Center for Disability Services/SNAP office at 843.953.1431 or at snap@cofc.edu. You can find additional information and request academic accommodations at the *Center for Disability Services/SNAP website*.

INCLUSION

I will gladly honor your request to address you by the name and gender pronouns of your choice. Please advise me of this early in the semester via your college-issued email account or during office hours so that I may make the appropriate notation on my class list.

The College of Charleston community is enriched by students of many faiths that have various religious observances, practices, and beliefs. We value student rights and freedoms, including the right of each student to adhere to individual systems of religion. The College prohibits discrimination against any student because of such student's religious belief or any absence thereof.

The College acknowledges that religious practices differ from tradition to tradition and that the demands of religious observances in some traditions may cause conflicts with student schedules. In affirming this diversity, like many other colleges and universities, the College supports the concept of "reasonable accommodation for religious observance" in regard to class attendance, and the scheduling of examinations and other academic work requirements, unless the accommodation would create an undue hardship on the College. Faculty are required, as part of

their responsibility to students and the College, to ascribe to this policy and to ensure its fair and full implementation.
The accommodation request imposes responsibilities and obligations on both the individual requesting the accommodation and the College. Faculty members are expected to reasonably accommodate individual religious practices. Examples of reasonable accommodations for student absences might include: rescheduling of an exam or giving a make-up exam for the student in question; altering the time of a student's presentation; allowing extra-credit assignments to substitute for missed class work or arranging for an increased flexibility in assignment dates. Regardless of any accommodation that may be granted, students are responsible for satisfying all academic objectives, requirements and prerequisites as defined by the instructor and by the College.

MENTAL AND PHYSICAL WELLBEING
At the college, we take every students' mental and physical wellbeing seriously. If you find yourself experiencing physical illnesses, please reach out to student health services (843.953.5520). And if you find yourself experiencing any mental health challenges (for example, anxiety, depression, stressful life events, sleep deprivation, and/or loneliness/homesickness) please consider contacting either the Counseling Center (professional counselors at http://counseling.cofc.edu or 843.953.5640 3rd Robert Scott Small Building) or the Students 4 Support (certified volunteers through texting "4support" to 839863, visit http://counseling.cofc.edu/cct/index.php, or meet with them in person 3rd Floor Stern Center). These services are there for you to help you cope with difficulties you may be experiencing and to maintain optimal physical and mental health.

FOOD AND HOUSING RESOURCES
Many CofC students report experiencing food and housing insecurity. If you are facing challenges in securing food (such as not being able to afford groceries or get sufficient food to eat every day) and housing (such as lacking a safe and stable place to live), please contact the Dean of Students for support (http://studentaffairs.cofc.edu/about/salt.php). Also, you can go to http://studentaffairs.cofc.edu/student-food-housing-insecurity/index.php to learn about food and housing assistance that is available to you. In addition, there are several resources on and off campus to help. You can visit the Cougar Pantry in the Stern Center (2nd floor), a student-run food pantry that provides dry-goods and hygiene products at no charge to any student in need.

OAKS
OAKS, including the Gradebook, will be used for this course throughout the semester to provide the syllabus and class materials and grades for each assignment, which will be regularly posted.

INCLEMENT WEATHER, PANDEMIC OR SUBSTANTIAL INTERRUPTION OF INSTRUCTION
If in-person classes are suspended, faculty will announce to their students a detailed plan for a change in modality to ensure the continuity of learning. All students must have access to a computer equipped with a web camera, microphone, and Internet access. Resources are available to provide students with these essential tools.

COURSE EVALUATIONS

Your constructive feedback is welcomed throughout the semester. In addition, you will be asked to formally evaluate your professor at the end of the semester. The link to complete this online evaluation will appear in your OAKS account. You are free to complete this evaluation at your leisure. We will also set aside time Monday, November 23rd in class to complete evaluations.

ACADEMIC RECORDS
Your academic records are your property. Please note that third parties cannot have access to your information without your prior consent.

GENERATIVE ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE
Generative Artificial Intelligence (GAI) tools are not permitted for any work in this class. If you use GAI tools, your actions would be considered academically dishonest and a violation of the College of Charleston's Honor Code and Code of Conduct. Students are bound by honor and by their enrollment at the College to abide by the specific policies of the Honor Code and the Code of Conduct, and to report any violations of the Honor System. All work submitted in this course must be your own, completed in accordance with the College's Honor Code. You may not engage in unauthorized collaboration or make use of ChatGPT or other GAI tools.

Since writing, analytical, and critical thinking skills are part of the learning outcomes of this course, all writing assignments should be prepared solely by the student and without any assistance. Questions in this regard should be shared directly with your professor. Developing strong competencies in this area will prepare you for a competitive workplace. Therefore, support of any generative artificial intelligence (GAI) tools is not permitted, and submissions using GAI will be treated as plagiarism per the College of Charleston's Honor Code.

Automated Writing Tools
Unless otherwise specified, the use of generative artificial intelligence (GAI), including ChatGPT and similar tools, is strictly prohibited in this course, even when appropriately referenced. The use of automated writing tools will be considered plagiarism and a violation of the CofC Honor Code.

CAMPUS RESOURCES
Center for Student Learning:
I encourage you to utilize the Center for Student Learning's (CSL) academic support services for assistance in study strategies and course content. They offer tutoring, supplemental instruction, study skills appointments, and workshops. Students of all abilities have become more successful using these programs throughout their academic career and the services are available to you at no additional cost. For more information regarding these services please visit the CSL website at http://csl.cofc.edu or call (843)953-5635.

Speaking Lab:
Did you know that there is a Speaking Lab in the Center for Student Learning? Well, there is! Speaking Lab consultants are there to guide you in the organization and development of your speech content and give you feedback on your speech delivery. They will even time your speech for you and help you add or cut out information, so you meet the time limits! If you are feeling

exceptionally nervous, the Speaking Lab has tools to help with stage fright, as well. The Speaking Lab hosts Walk-In Wednesdays from 1-3 in the Center for Student Learning, during which no appointment is needed. Otherwise, the Speaking Lab is a by-appointment-only lab, so you need to go to By Appointment Tutoring - College of Charleston (cofc.edu) and click on "Speaking Lab," then follow the instructions to make your appointment. Alternatively, you can call 843-953-5635, the front desk for the Center for Student Learning, for assistance.

STUDENT OBLIGATIONS

Total = 1000 points

Assignments (350 points)

Annotated Bibliographies (two) (100 points)
Finding Fallacies (50 points)
In-Class Quizzes (14 Total, 4 of which will drop) (200 points)

Classroom Engagement (200 points)

Audience Analysis One (50 points)
Audience Analysis Two (50 points)
Presence on Speaking Days (15 Total, 5 of which will drop) (100 points)

Speeches (450 points)

Introductory Speech (50 points)
Informative Speech (150 points)
Persuasive Speech (150 points)
Pecha Kucha Speech (100 points)

TENTATIVE CALENDAR

	Theme	Reading	Assignments & Notifications
8-17 (M)	Introduction to the Course	Syllabus	
8-19 (W)	Public Speaking: An Introduction	*Speech Craft* (pgs. 2-11)	**Quiz:**
8-21 (F)	Basic Speech Preparation	*Speech Craft* (pgs. 11-18)	Quiz #1 on OAKS (this is the only quiz that will take place on OAKS)
Speaking with Intention			
8-24 (M)	Listening and Ethics	*Speech Craft* (pgs. 22-42)	
8-26 (W)	Interview Your Peer	Attendance Required	
8-28 (F)	Selecting a Topic & Purpose	*Speech Craft* (pgs. 77-86)	**Quiz:** Quiz #2 (on 8-28)
Analyzing and Planning for Your Speaking Situation			
8-31 (M)	Introductory Speeches	Attendance Required	
9-2 (W)	Introductory Speeches	Attendance Required	
9-4 (F)	Developing a Thesis Statement Informative Speaking	*Speech Craft* (pgs. 87-88) *Speech Craft* (pgs. 276-292)	**Quiz:** Quiz #3 (on 9-4)
Research			
9-7 (M)	Introduction to Research	*Speech Craft* (pgs. 92-101)	
9-9 (W)	Types of Support	*Speech Craft* (pgs. 110-122-101)	**Quiz:** Quiz #4 (on 9-7) Quiz #5 (on 9-11)
9-11 (F)	Citations and Research Tips	*Speech Craft* (pgs. 102-106)	
Informative Speaking			
9-14 (M)	Audience Analyses	*Speech Craft* (pgs. 46-71)	**Assignment:** Audience Analysis One (DUE 9-21) on OAKS
9-16 (W)	Outlining	*Speech Craft* (pgs. 134-160)	**Quiz:**
9-18 (F)	Audience Analysis One	Attendance Required	Quiz #6 (on 9-18)
Crafting your Delivery			
9-21 (M)	Complete Audience One Reconstructing a Speech		
9-23 (W)	Delivery Introductions & Conclusions	*Speech Craft* (pgs. 202-218) and *Speech Craft* (pgs. 164-176)	**Assignment:** Annotated Bibliography One (DUE 9-24) on OAKS
9-25 (F)	Style and Language Choices	*Speech Craft* (pgs. 180-198)	**Quiz:** Quiz #7 (on 9-25)
Informative Speeches			
9-28 (M)	Informative Speeches	Attendance Required	**Assignment:** Informative Speeches (outlines due on assigned speaking day on OAKS)
9-30 (W)	Informative Speeches	Attendance Required	
10-2 (F)	Informative Speeches	Attendance Required	

Introduction to Argument			
10-5 (M)	Introduction to Argumentation/Fallacies	*Speech Craft* (pgs. 315-339)	**Assignment:** Finding Fallacies (DUE 10-9) on OAKS **Quiz:** Quiz #8 (DUE 10-9 on OAKS)
10-7 (W)	Fallacy Assignment	See online guide – no formal meeting	
10-9 (F)	Fallacy Assignment & Quiz #8 DUE ON OAKS	No formal meeting	
Persuasive Speaking			
10-12 (M)	NO CLASS	Fall Break	**Quiz:** Quiz #9 (on 10-16)
10-14 (W)	Persuasive Speaking; A Guide	*Speech Craft* (pgs. 295-313)	
10-16 (F)	Persuasive Speaking (cont.)		
Speech Preparation			
10-19 (M)	Audience Analysis Two	Attendance Required	**Assignment:** Audience Analysis Two (DUE 10-21) on OAKS Annotated Bibliography Two (DUE 10-25) on OAKS **Quiz:** Quiz #10 (on 10-21)
10-21 (W)	Audience Analysis – Follow Up		
10-23 (F)	Research Day		
Persuasive Speeches			
10-26 (M)	Persuasive Speeches	Attendance Required	**Assignment:** Persuasive Speeches (outlines due on assigned speaking day on OAKS) **Quiz:** Quiz #11 (on 10-26)
10-28 (W)	Persuasive Speeches	Attendance Required	
10-30 (F)	Persuasive Speeches	Attendance Required	
11-2 (M)	Persuasive Speeches	Attendance Required	
Visual Aids			
11-4 (W)	Visual Aids	*Speech Craft* (pgs. 221-239)	**Quiz:** Quiz #12 (on 11-6)
11-6 (F)	Introduction to Pecha Kuchas		
Pecha Kucha Speeches			
11-9 (M)	Speech Preparation		**Assignment:** Pecha Kucha Speeches (slides due on assigned speaking day on OAKS) **Quiz:** Quiz #13 (on 11-13) Quiz #14 (on 11-23)
11-11 (W)	Speech Preparation		
11-13 (F)	Pecha Kucha Speeches	Attendance Required	
11-16 (M)	Pecha Kucha Speeches	Attendance Required	
11-18 (W)	Pecha Kucha Speeches	Attendance Required	
11-20 (F)	Pecha Kucha Speeches	Attendance Required	
11-23 (M)	Final Quiz and Course Evaluations		